

# MAKING INDIAN SILICON ESSENTIAL

**Applied Materials'**  
**Avi Avula** on how India  
wins the chip game

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**“T**here’s no sovereign silicon, in my view,” Avi Avula tells me, without mincing his words.

The semiconductor industry is so sophisticated that without interdependency and collaboration between critical players and enablers, it can’t survive.

“This industry is so evolved, it’s so advanced that no one company can do everything. And so you have to be dependent on companies who build specialty expertise over decades,” he says.

Avi spells out why, using the kind of unromantic truth that only exists inside fabs and supply chains. “The US can’t make a chip on its own today, even if it wanted to. Neither can Taiwan, neither can Japan,” he says. That’s why he swats away the tempting shortcut in India’s narrative: “It does not make sense to say, I’ll do everything in India.”